

KIMYO INTERNATIONAL UNIVERSITY IN TASHKENT



THE 5<sup>TH</sup> REPUBLICAN STUDENTS'  
SCIENTIFIC PRACTICAL CONFERENCE ON THE TOPIC

ENGLISH FOR  
SPECIFIC  
PURPOSES

**THE ROLE OF  
ESP & EAP**

ENGLISH FOR  
ACADEMIC  
PURPOSES

**IN GLOBAL  
COMMUNICATION  
PROGRAMME**



**UDC 811.111:316.77**

**LBC 81.2Engl**

**J 78**

**Joldasbaeva, P.**

The role of esp and eap in global communication [Text] / P. Joldasbaeva, S. Meliyeva, Sh. Keldiyarova .-Toshkent: Dizayn market, 2025.- 384 p.

**EDITORS:**

*Joldasbaeva Palzada*

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**ISBN 978-9910-8014-9-5**

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guarantee that training materials are current and useful. Technology integration can also improve accessibility and offer real-world communication possibilities. Examples of this include online learning platforms.

In conclusion, when it comes to giving professionals and students the language abilities they need for international communication, ESP and EAP are essential. EAP equips students for both academic performance and cross-cultural interaction, whereas ESP strengthens industry-specific competency. The efficiency of ESP and EAP programs will be further increased by addressing implementation issues through focused curriculum development and technology integration.

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### **DISTRACTING FROM DISTRACTORS: USING HUMOUR TO ENGAGE STUDENTS IN EAP CLASSES**

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**Annotation:** The current article explores how to attract students' attention to classroom activities in English for academic purposes (EAP) seminars by using humour. It relies on the conclusions drawn from the extensive literature review. An example of an activity based on using humour approach in EAP seminars is illustrated to help future educators prepare for working in transnational English medium instruction (EMI) universities.

**Key words:** *English for academic purposes, humour, engagement, distractors*

### **Introduction**

Students may get bored with the lesson flow in EAP classes (the same case may also happen in other disciplines), and students tend to lose their concentration, which works as bait for distractions such as students' devices and chatting with their friends. While one cannot change the nature of EAP classes in the sense that grammar, different textual patterns, specific vocabulary need to be taught, which can indeed sometimes be tedious, one can change the approaches to how these elements can be taught. This paper explores possible ways to integrate humour to draw students' attention and engage them in classroom activities. Thus, this paper will present a theoretical background on why humour can effectively motivate students to re-engage and become more active during classes.

### **Literature review**

Humour is not new for modern pedagogy, as several research papers have accentuated the benefits of using humour in the classroom. Moreover, in pedagogy, one of the trending approaches is Humour Integrated Language Learning (HILL).

### **Definition of humour**

Firstly, it can be of great use to define humour for the purposes of the current article. As in literature one can find various definitions, it is complicated to choose one unanimous definition of humour (Raff, 2005). Davis (2008) provided the following definition: "Humor is any sudden episode of joy or elation associated with a new discovery that is self-rated funny" (p. 547). Ziv (1986) described humour as a form of communication and proposes the following definition "Humour is a form of communication with an intent to amuse, including special cognitive and emotional characteristics, that cause a physiological reaction" (p.9). The physiological reaction that humour can stimulate is laughter (Dziemidok, 1974), but laughter is not always the usual reaction. It should be noted that laughter can also be incentivized by other stimuli (e.g. tickling, nervousness, triumph, approval, contempt, shame, etc.). Likewise, sometimes a reaction to a humorous instance can be a smile, verbal acknowledgement, a smile with a verbal acknowledgement or telling another joke in response (Kuipers, 2008). Titze and Eschenruder (2011) use humour as a generic term to describe the whole field of the comical or funny. As can be drawn from

the definitions, humour can be used as an umbrella term for all forms of comical and funniness and sometimes is used interchangeably with the term comic. Humour indicates the ability of human beings to laugh at difficult situations and shortcomings in life, and thus humour gives people the feeling of alleviation. It is a universal human feature - a defensive tool that helps humans stay positive.

### **Humour and Pedagogy**

According to research findings of Al-Duleimi and Aziz (2016, p.112), humour mainly is a good remedy against boredom during the lesson, which may hinder the learning process. Furthermore, Al-Duleimi and Aziz (2016) they count six advantages of humour's integration into the class: 1. humour is a wished personal teacher's trait in the class; 2. it breaks the ice effectively; 3. humour brings comfort to students and thus makes them receptive to the lesson's material; 4. humour engages students in the activities and corrects their mistakes in a more milder and amusing way; 5 it fosters deep learning; 6. it connects people by melting the cultural borders (p.112). Akhmadulina and Valiahmetova (2019), in their work "Pedagogical Competence", highlighted that humour plays different roles in pedagogical practice. They accounted for humour as one of the integral characteristics of a pedagogically competent teacher, as humour helps teachers look at some challenging pedagogical issues with a glimpse of positive energy and a method of relaxation. It helps them to communicate with students in a friendly manner (when they encourage students to do a task or make a remark without being tough).

### **Humour in EAP classes**

Using humour in EAP classes, its roles and benefits and limitations were not widely explored. However, it can be noted that the pedagogical peculiarities of using humour as a pedagogical tool (e.g. to create a favourable atmosphere in the classroom) or as a material (e.g. using humorous texts, audio and video files to teach a certain aspect of Academic English) can also be applied to EAP classes.

### **Humour as a pedagogical tool**

It was stated in previous research that teachers utilize humour to establish a pleasant atmosphere to make students feel more open and not stressed during the classes which helps to lower the affective filter (Krashen, 1985). Moreover, teachers use humour to build rapport with students (Chergui, 2018), engage them in group activities and mildly correct students' mistakes when providing feedback. It can be highlighted that students enjoy the classes in which humour is used

constructively. They feel more engaged in discussions and are open to asking questions from the teacher without feeling anxious during the classes. In the classes where teachers initiate humour, students also tend to use humour if the situation allows it. Moreover, students retain the material taught during the class better (Garner, 2006). Humour is effective provided that it is planned and related to the lesson's content. Besides, teachers should avoid using derogatory humour towards students, which may demotivate them. Using humour should be balanced, and teachers need to follow some limits on which topic to joke about (e.g. not to joke about explicit, obscene topics).

### **Humour vs. distractors**

Needless to say, Zoomers are the generation that was already born during the period of technological inventions. Therefore, it is sometimes easy for them to lose engagement and become sidetracked by gadgets. Besides, if stricter rules are accepted for using gadgets in specific classrooms according to policies, students can involuntarily engage in a 'small talk' with groupmates. Technology-integrated or enhanced EAP classes make the classes more appealing and attractive to students (Smith, 2013). However, not all EAP instructors can integrate technology into their classrooms for several reasons (e.g. lack of knowledge of frameworks on how to use technology in the classroom, lack of necessary technology itself and time constraints). In this case, using humour to engage students creates favourable opportunities as this resource is available anytime.

One of the examples of activities that build on implementation humour in EAP classes is using false citations and holding a competition between students to find accurate and false citations to strengthen referencing skills. The citations can be created in a funny way in order to keep students' attention and make them engaged:

### **Procedure:**

1. Compile a list of 8-10 references. Some of them should be references to real sources, whereas some should be created using humour. To create a list which will have a humorous impact, one can use exaggerations, incongruity and pop culture. For the funny references to be more credible, the references should imitate academic referencing principles.

- a) Rowling, J. (2018) How magic can help to write your research paper? *Journal of Wizardry*, 118(7), 478-488

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2. Ask students to read the references and find those which are true, and which are false.

3. After students define the true and false references, the teacher can encourage students to create true and false references themselves for practising purposes.

4. After students are done creating true and false references, they can be assigned pairs to exchange their materials and try to detect the true and false references their partners created.

### **Conclusion**

English for academic purposes is one of the fundamental disciplines to excel in academia further, be it embarking on degree studies or writing academic texts for different purposes, presenting the results of research, or developing other academic skills. However, teachers are mostly faced with students being distracted during classes by different gadgets or students' off-topic chats. While there are other methods on how to help students stay on track with the lesson's plan, humour can be used as a pedagogical tool and as material to keep students engaged and active during the classes. As a pedagogical tool, humour can be used to establish a light atmosphere in the classroom, which encourages students to freely share their ideas, build rapport with students and correct students' mistakes in a more friendly manner. Besides, humour can be used as learning materials based on the learning outcomes of the respective session or activity. Teachers need to follow some limitations such as not using derogatory humour, which might overcriticize student/students and relate the humour to the lesson's content, as well as following some limitations regarding the topics to joke about.

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## K-POP AND KOREAN DRAMA: BRIDGING CULTURES THOUGH ESP AND EAP IN GLOBAL COMMUNICATION

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**Annotation:** this article explores the importance of English for Special Purposes (ESP) and English for Academic Purposes (EAP) from a global perspective in relation to the new phenomenon of K-pop and Korean drama. It will explore the way English is used in the K-pop industry through song lyrics, interviews, and marketing to a global audience and international fan awareness. This study will also examine theoretical texts related to the use of English subtitles or dubbing in Korean dramas to reach a wider audience, as well as the use of academic English in Korean dramas in an academic context. I argue that k-pop and Korean dramas provide a means to overcome culture by enhancing intercultural communication and mutual understanding though lan-